

THE ILM FOUNDATION

Education Group Publication

ORGANIZATION UPDATE:

- Total number of **students sponsored**: **41** students (additional 6 students under one time aid)
- Total amount **collected in May**: ₹ 56,840
- Total amount **spent in May**: ₹ 54,106
- **Zakat collected and spent in May**: ₹ 1,12,771



PEARLS OF WISDOM

Muhammad, upon him be peace, said: "When a man dies, his deeds come to an end except for three things: Sadaqah Jariyah (ceaseless charity); a knowledge which is beneficial, or a virtuous descendant who prays for him (for the deceased)." (Muslim)

Reference:
Riyad as-Salihin 1383
In-book reference:
Book 12, Hadith 8

FORGING NEW PATHS

Saba Shaikh is a final year IT engineering student at Saboo Siddik College in Mumbai. She comes from a family of 6 where she is the eldest child. Her father works in a garment shop and has since the pandemic last year struggled with paying Saba's college fees. With the aid of the group, the India Zakat foundation was able to collect enough money to pay the fees for her third year. The college is now deciding on the waiver for the final year fees. Like many fresh engineering graduates, Saba hopes to get a job as a front end developer. She is working hard for her college placements and off-campus as well. She shows promise and we hope that she is able to secure a job and assist her family financially as well.

[To learn more about the beneficiaries, click here to access the drive link](#)

AQABAH AND THE PANDEMIC

By Sadiqua Sadaf

I joined ILM Foundation in June of last year and my time with this organisation has largely coincided with the course of the COVID pandemic. While some of us have had the good fortune of surviving some of its worst blows, others have had to bear its full brunt. And the disparity has never been more evident than in the past few months.

This year has underscored the importance of an often overlooked privilege - the illusion of certainty. The privilege of monotony and being able to live for weeks and months without having to worry about basic amenities. The blessing of a life that is fairly predictable in its course. The sheer bounty of never having to depend on a broken government to meet our needs and requirements.

What, for some of us, is an exceptional, once in a millennium circumstance has always been the norm for millions of families in this country, living paycheque to paycheque - some of whom this organisation is generously trying to support.

I was struggling to cope with academic delays, crippling uncertainty and a general sense of the world falling apart. My mind was fixated on a possible return of normalcy. 'Once this is over, I'm going to be alright'. But it never did come.

This pandemic, as we've come to realise, isn't a temporary bump in the road. **It's a shift in our collective trajectory.** In just under a year, it's transformed the way we live, the way we interact with others and the way we react to situations. It's become our new normal. And with something so profound and rapid as this change, pretending that everything will go back to what it once was, only prolongs our suffering.

What I needed, and what we all need in these unprecedented times, is a shift in perspective. For us to learn to respond to this uncertainty with gratitude. To develop the ability to make the most of what we have and what is instead of lamenting over what could've been.

As the Prophet(ﷺ) taught us, **'If anyone of you looked at a person who was made superior to him in property and (in good) appearance, then he should also look at the one who is inferior to him.'** (Sahih Bukhari 6490)

My time with this group has allowed me to internalise this valuable lesson. In trying to address the challenges in the lives of my mentees, I'm constantly reminded of the blessings in my own. Watching them deal with their circumstances through patience and resilience has given me hope for my own.

It's made me aware of the absolute honour of being able to help others at a time of dire need as it's mentioned in Surah Balad,

'And what can make you know what is the 'Aqabah (Difficult Pass)? It is the freeing of a slave. Or feeding on a day of severe hunger - an orphan of near relationship, or a needy person in misery. And then being among those who believed and advised one another to patience and advised one another to compassion.' (Surat Al-Balad, Verses 12-17)

'Aqabah' is traditionally translated as a 'steep climb' or a 'difficult pass' - an arduous moral undertaking that requires man to overcome his base desires and perform good deeds commanded by Allah (SWT).

To save someone from humiliation.

To pull someone up from the pits of despair.

To be there for someone on a day when they have no one.

To be Allah's answer to their most poignant Duas.

May Allah (SWT) grant Sakeena to those who are suffering during these unprecedented times and may He allow those, who have been going out of their way to help others in this time of great need, the full reward for undertaking this 'Aqabah.

And spend in the way of Allah and do not throw [yourselves] with your [own] hands into destruction [by refraining]. And do good; indeed, Allah loves the doers of good. **Al Qur'an 2:195**